Brazilian president's cell phone. In an open letter to the Brazilian people, Snowden said he would help Brazil investigate NSA spying in its country. But Brazilian officials said it was highly unlikely Snowden would ever be granted asylum; the country was afraid of jeopardizing its relationship with the United States. Snowden also explored asylum in Germany, France, and Switzerland. In June 2015, French Minister Christiane Taubira said it was possible her country might offer Snowden asylum. But as of December 2015, nothing had come of those requests.

On August 7, 2014, the Russian government announced Snowden had been granted a permit that would allow him to stay in the country for another three years. Snowden was grateful to have a safe place to live for the foreseeable future. In the summer of 2014, Snowden's girlfriend, Lindsay Mills, joined him in Moscow, and they were seen together out on dates. Tabloid rumors swirled the two might marry in Russia, but visa restrictions kept her from living in Russia full time.

Happy to have his girlfriend with him, Snowden nonetheless hoped to go home someday. He even told the US government he was willing to go to prison, as long

Copyright © 2016. ABDO Publishing Company. All rights reserved.

Edward Snowden: NSA Whistle-Blower, ABDO Publishing Company, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,